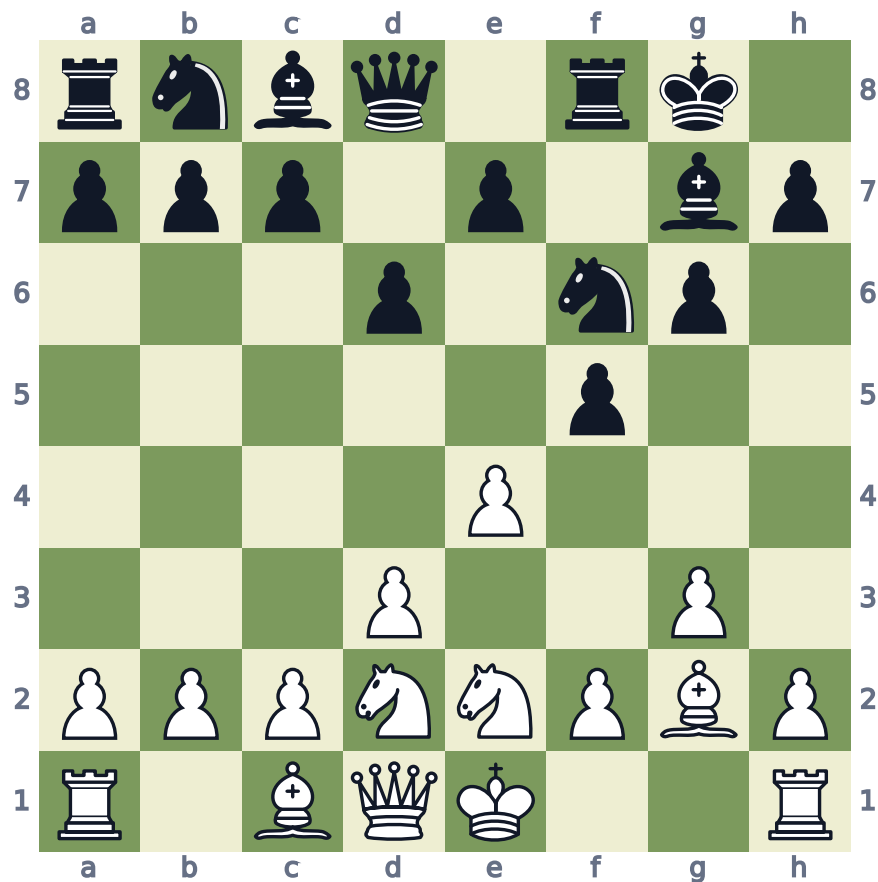


White Hippo vs Dutch, Owen, and Flank Setups

f5 centers, queenside fianchettos, unusual pawn moves, and central occupation



Meet Black's flank-first systems with a flexible shell while exploiting the central squares those pawn moves concede.

8 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Meet Black's flank-first systems with a flexible shell while exploiting the central squares those pawn moves concede.

THE WHITE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- Identify Black's center, both kings, and Black's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram compare e4, d4, c4, and f4 before choosing another setup move.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, purpose, and Black's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected 1.g3 repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the companion PGNs make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Against f5, the e4 square is White's primary strategic resource.

PRINCIPLE 2

A queenside fianchetto targets e4 and can create mutual long-diagonal tactics.

PRINCIPLE 3

Wing moves give White time for the center, not for a premature attack.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Black's b5 can be challenged with a4 or a central break.

PRINCIPLE 5

Unusual first moves should be met by development and central occupation.

PRINCIPLE 6

The Hippo is useful only while it improves the eventual center claim.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|----------------------------------|---|
| 01 | Leningrad Dutch structure | Against the Leningrad, e4 is the central prize. |
|
 | | |
| 02 | Classical Dutch center | Use e4 before Black completes a Stonewall shell. |
|
 | | |
| 03 | Owen queenside fianchetto | A queenside fianchetto is met by the center, not by chasing the bishop. |
|
 | | |
| 04 | Nimzowitsch-style Nc6 | Nc6 changes Black's c-pawn options; use that structural clue. |
|
 | | |
| 05 | Early h5 | A wing pawn is answered by the center unless it creates a forcing threat. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | Early a6-b5 | If b5 comes before a diagonal blocker, Bxa8 is the tactical answer. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | Polish-style b5 | Central occupation comes before hunting an advanced wing pawn. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | Borg-style g5 | Do not open the h-file before the center and king are secure. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Leningrad Dutch structure



COURSE LINE

1. g3 f5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 g6 4. Nd2 Bg7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 d6 7. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

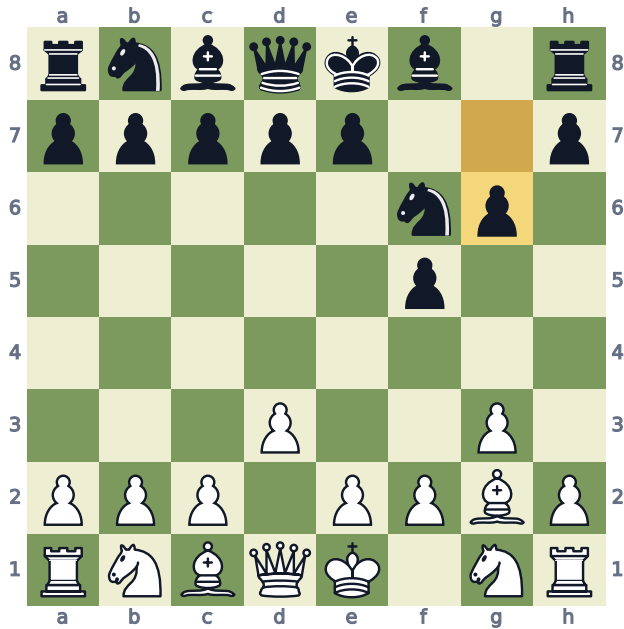
Occupy e4 and prepare f4 or a central exchange against Black's f-pawn.

MAIN DANGER

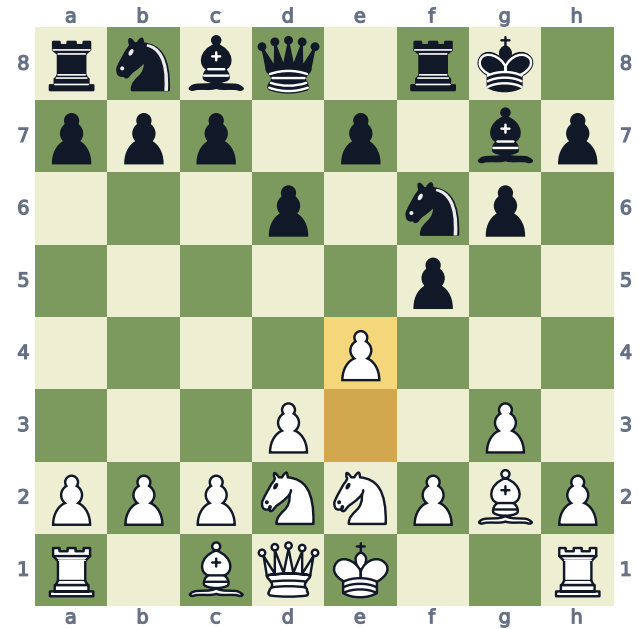
e5 and a kingside attack can arrive rapidly.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against the Leningrad, e4 is the central prize.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

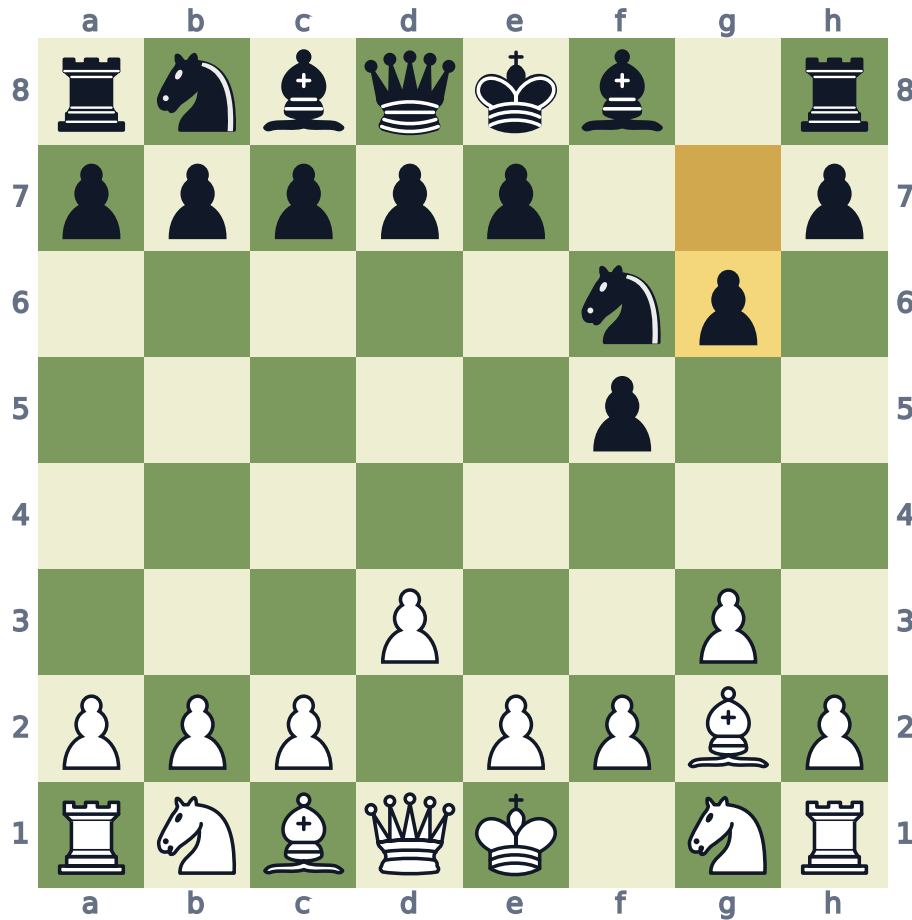
Position estimate: -0.30 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 O-O 2. e5 Nc4 3. fxe4 dxe4 4. Be6 Ne3 5. Qd7 Nc3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Leningrad Dutch structure



YOUR TASK

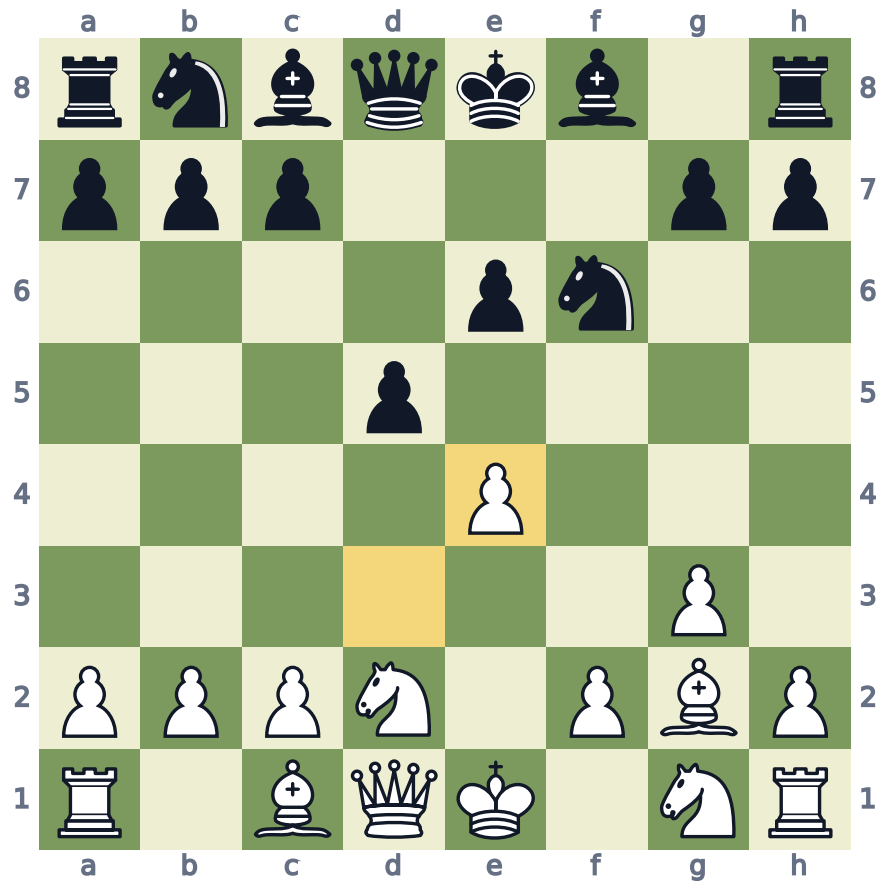
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Classical Dutch center



COURSE LINE

1. g3 f5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 e6 4. Nd2 d5 5. e4 fxe4 6. dxe4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

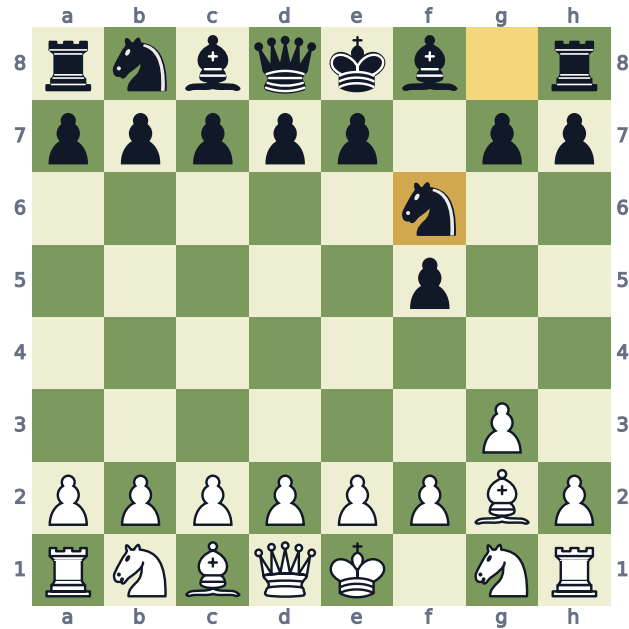
Open the center while Black's king and e6 pawn remain potential targets.

MAIN DANGER

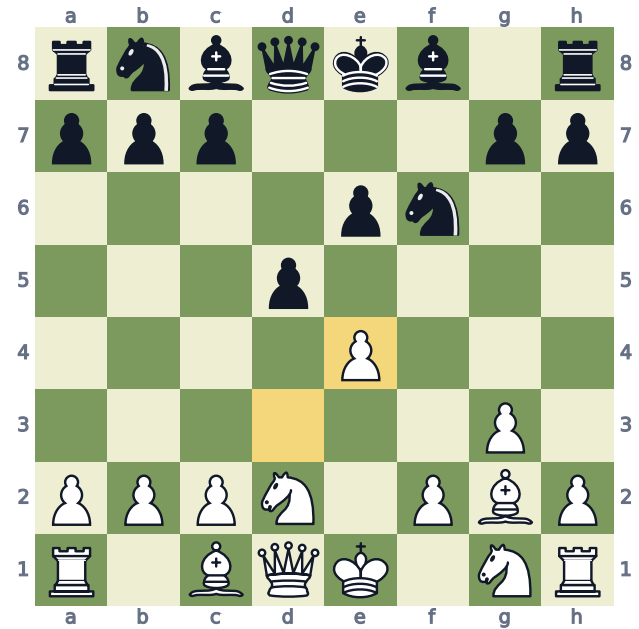
d4 can close the center and support a kingside attack.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Use e4 before Black completes a Stonewall shell.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

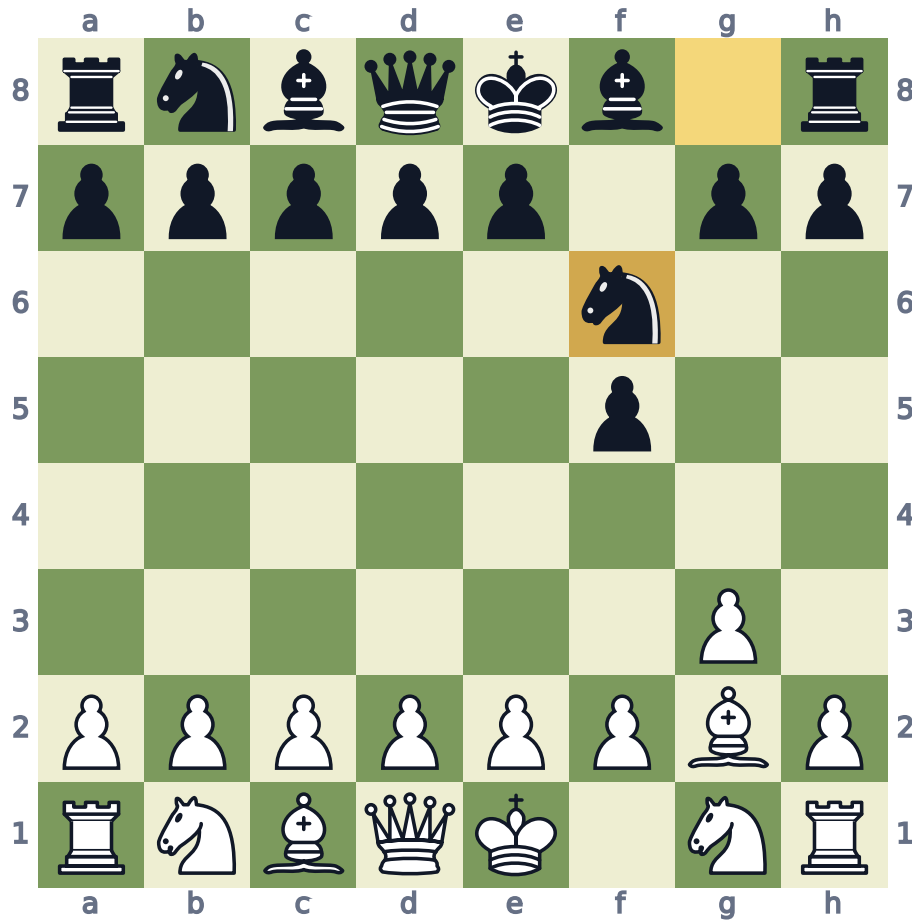
Position estimate: +0.33 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 c3 2. dxe4 Qe2 3. Qd3 Nxe4 4. Qxe2+ Nxe2 5. e5 O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Classical Dutch center



YOUR TASK

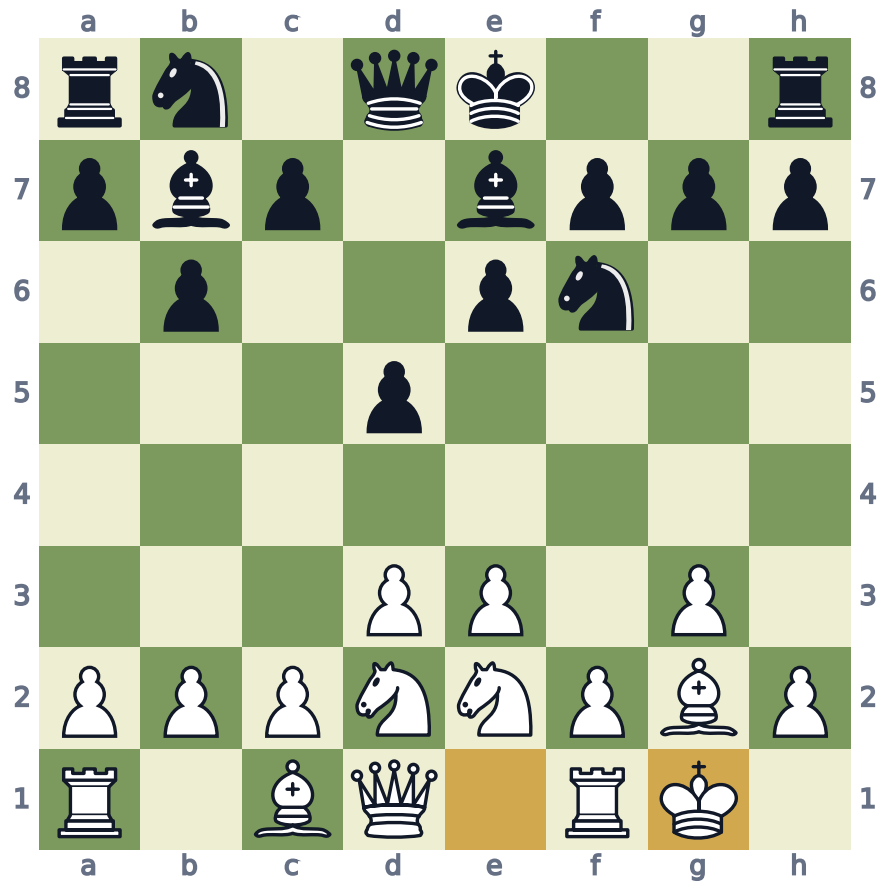
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Owen queenside fianchetto



COURSE LINE

1. g3 b6 2. Bg2 Bb7 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 Nf6 5. e3 e6 6. Ne2 Be7 7. O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use d5 to block the long diagonal and prepare e4 or c4.

MAIN DANGER

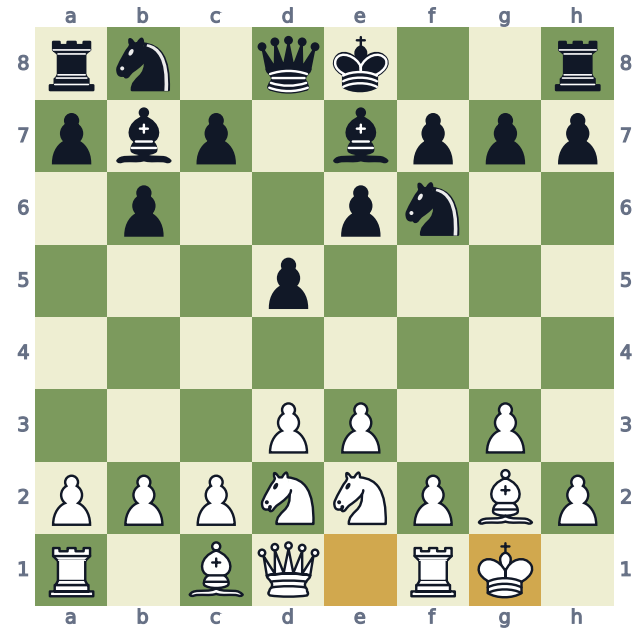
c5 may attack the center before White is ready.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A queenside fianchetto is met by the center, not by chasing the bishop.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

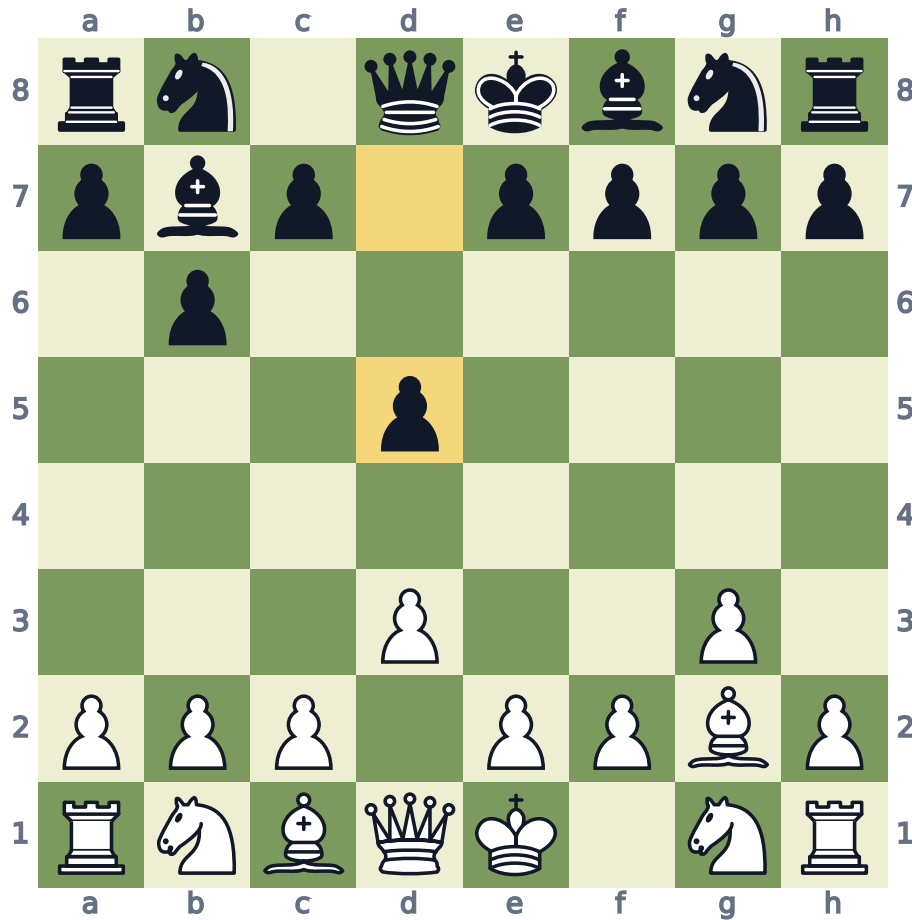
Position estimate: -0.25 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. O-O b3 2. c5 Bb2 3. Nc6 d4 4. Qc7 Nf4 5. cxd4 exd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Owen queenside fianchetto



YOUR TASK

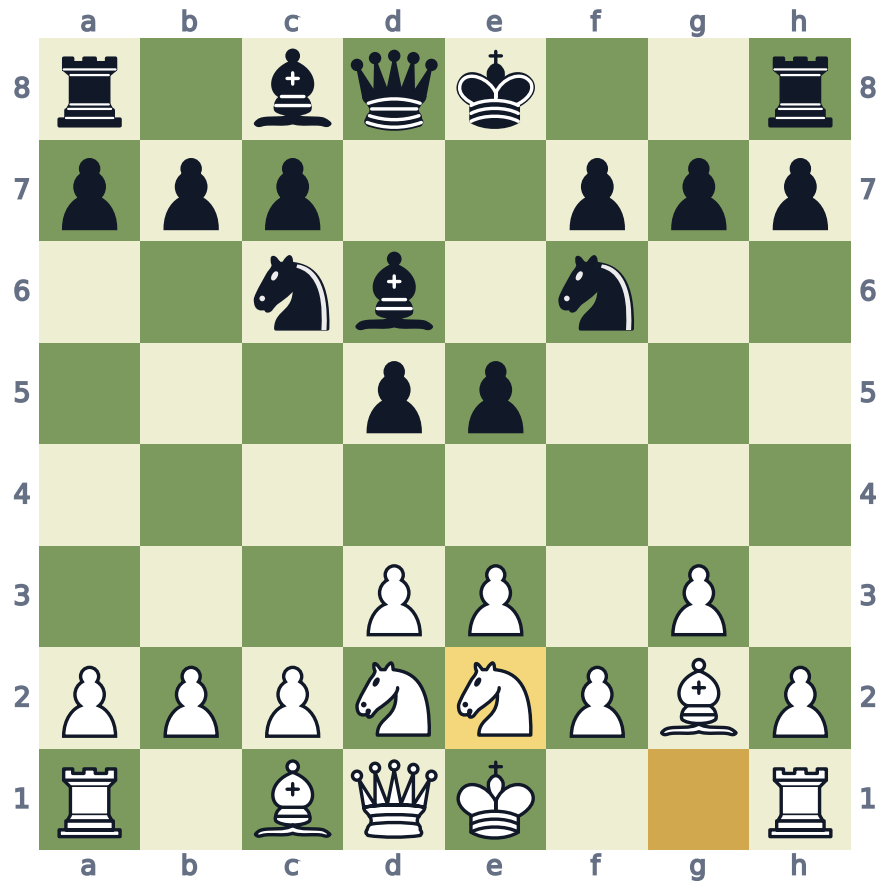
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Nimzowitsch-style Nc6



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nc6 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 Nf6 5. e3 Bd6 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

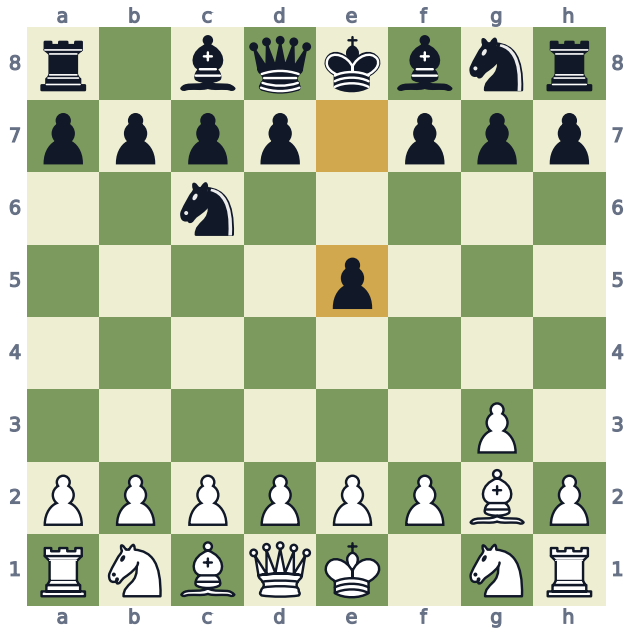
Prepare e4 or c4 while Black commits the knight in front of the c-pawn.

MAIN DANGER

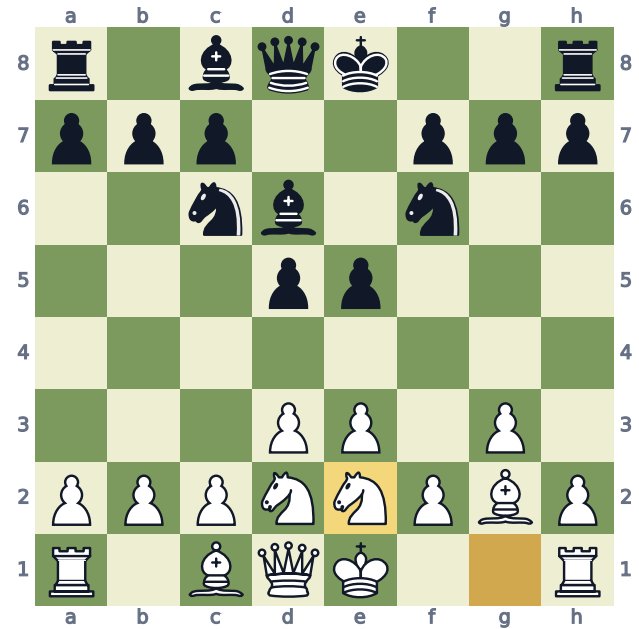
e4 can gain space and attack Nd2's routes.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Nc6 changes Black's c-pawn options; use that structural clue.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

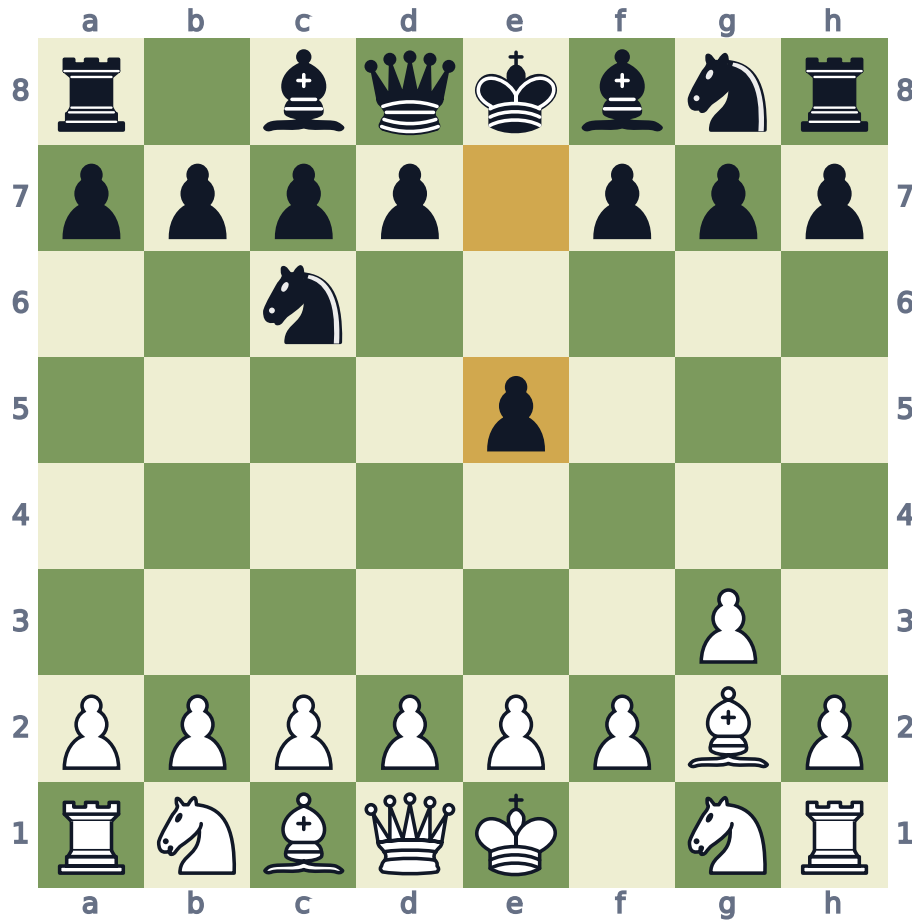
Position estimate: -0.76 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. h5 h3 2. Qe7 b3 3. Be6 a3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Nimzowitsch-style Nc6



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Early h5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 h5 2. Bg2 h4 3. d3 e5 4. Nd2 d5 5. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

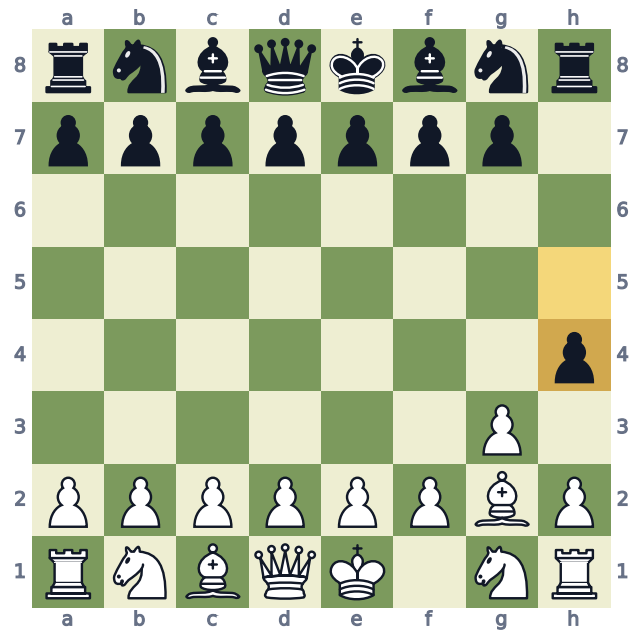
Counter the wing advance with central occupation and development.

MAIN DANGER

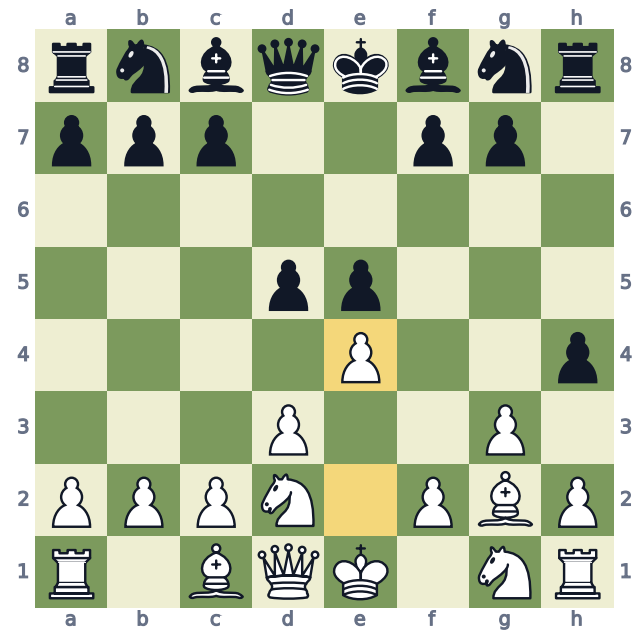
hxg3 can damage the kingside structure.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A wing pawn is answered by the center unless it creates a forcing threat.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

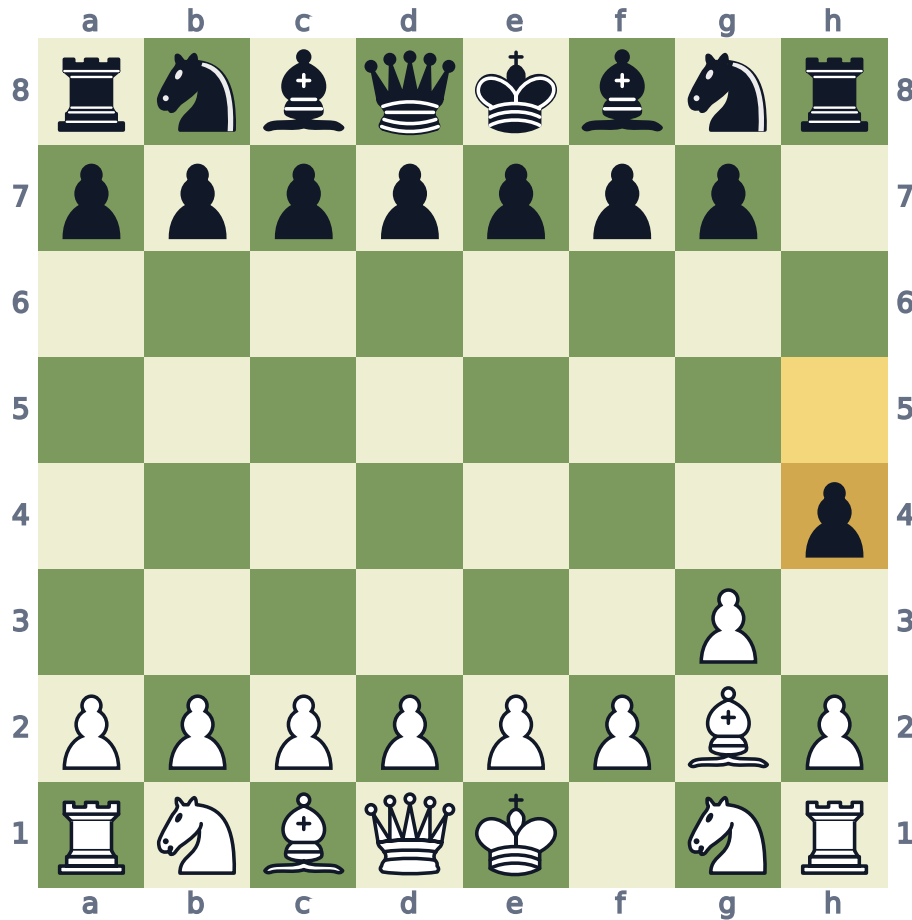
Position estimate: -0.87 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nf6 exd5 2. Nxd5 c3 3. Be6 Ngf3 4. h3 Bf1 5. Nc6 Be2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Early h5



YOUR TASK

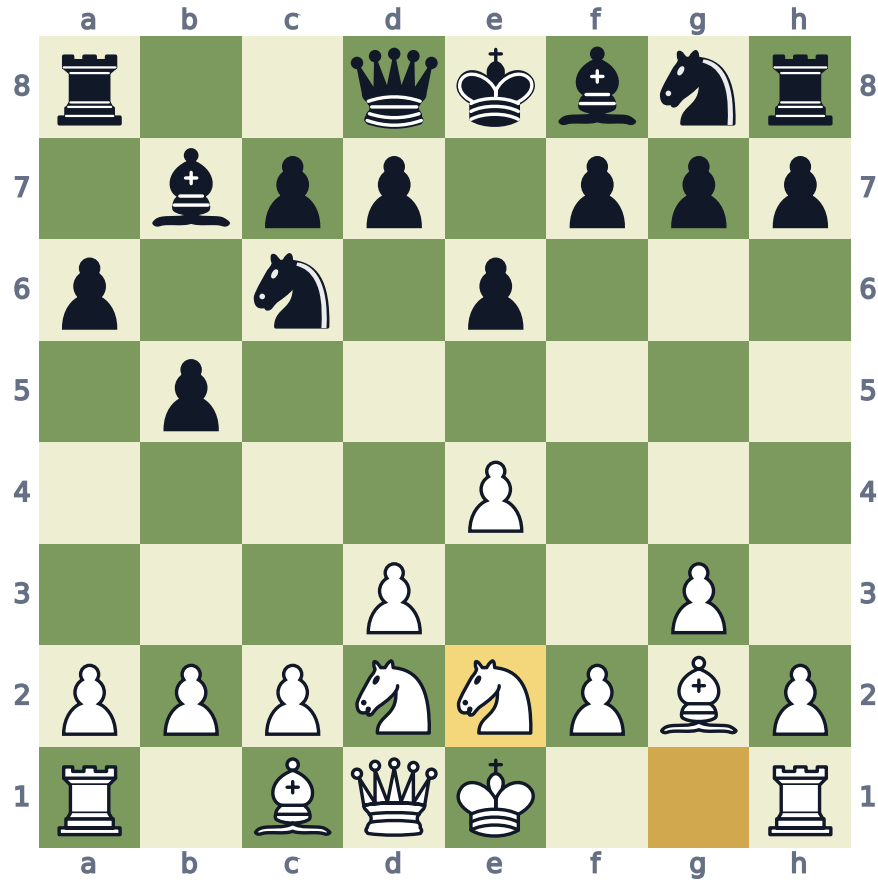
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Early a6-b5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 a6 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 b5 4. Nd2 Bb7 5. e4 e6 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

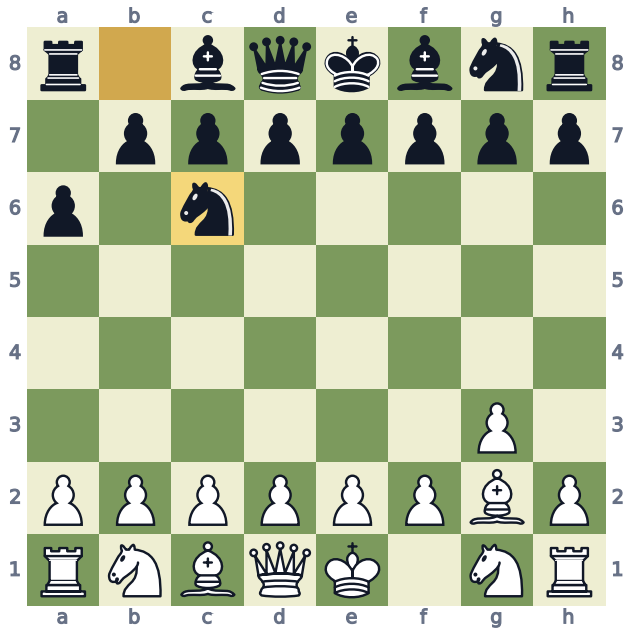
Use the c6 knight's diagonal block to develop, then occupy e4 and prepare a4.

MAIN DANGER

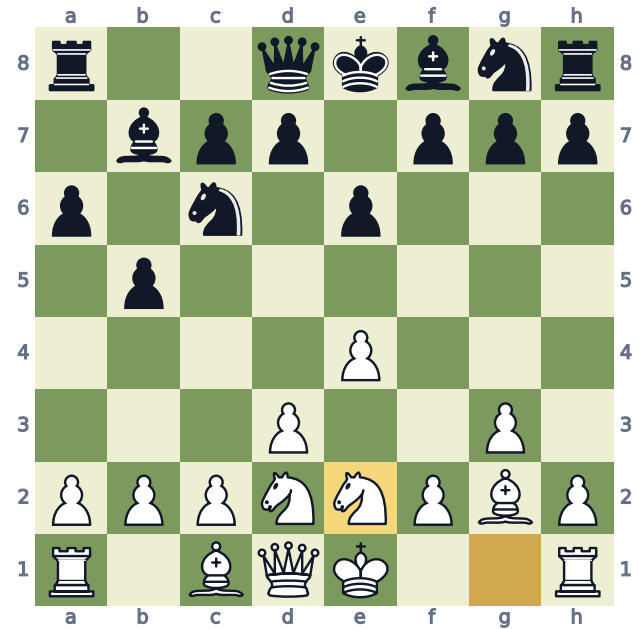
b4 can chase pieces and control c3.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

If b5 comes before a diagonal blocker, Bxa8 is the tactical answer.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

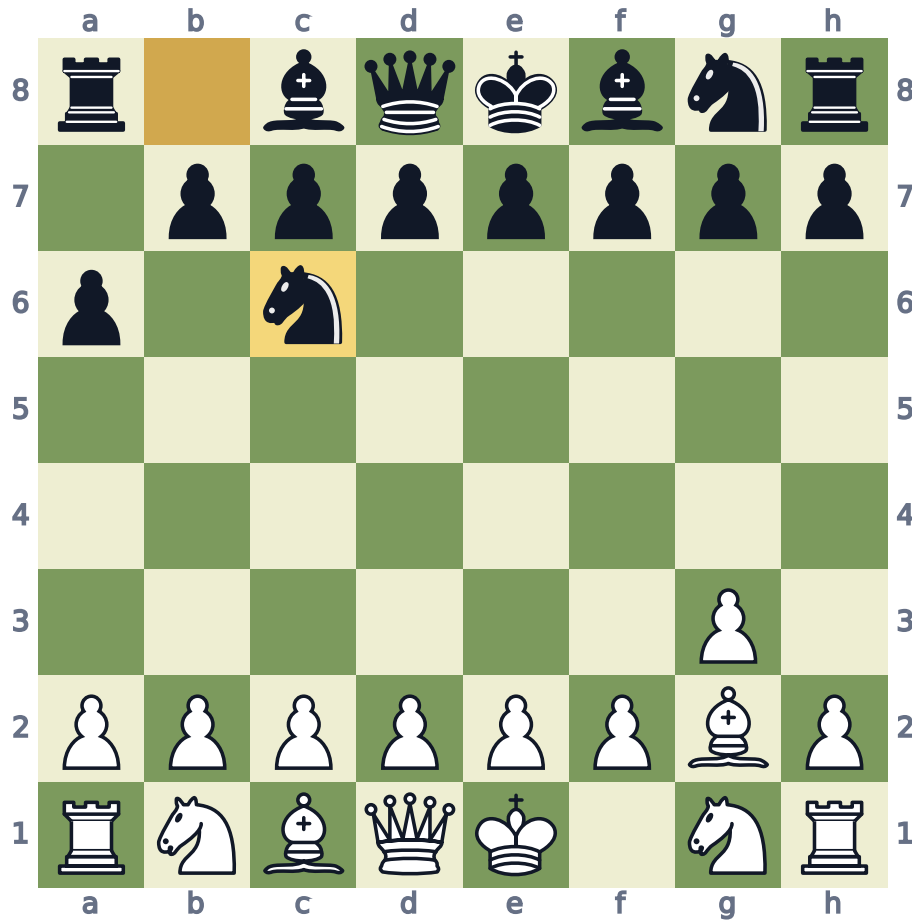
Position estimate: +0.44 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bc5 c3 2. Bb6 d4 3. d6 O-O 4. e5 b4 5. exd4 cxd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Early a6-b5



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Polish-style b5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 b5 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 e5 4. Nd2 Nf6 5. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

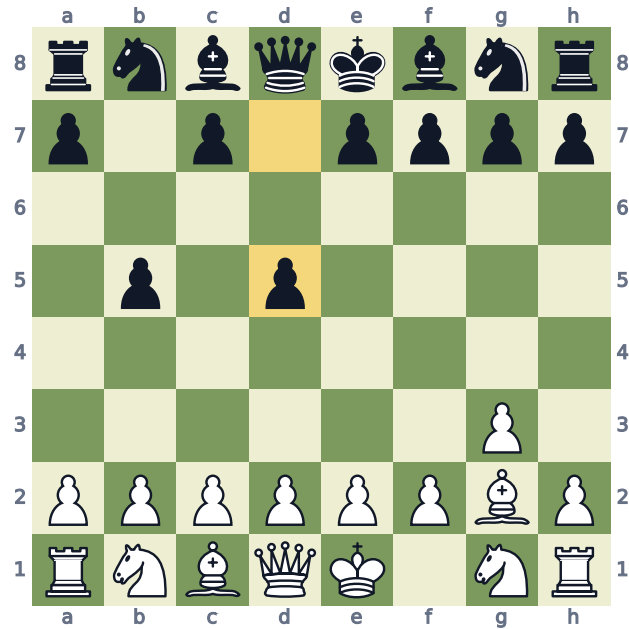
Build the center and later attack b5 with a4.

MAIN DANGER

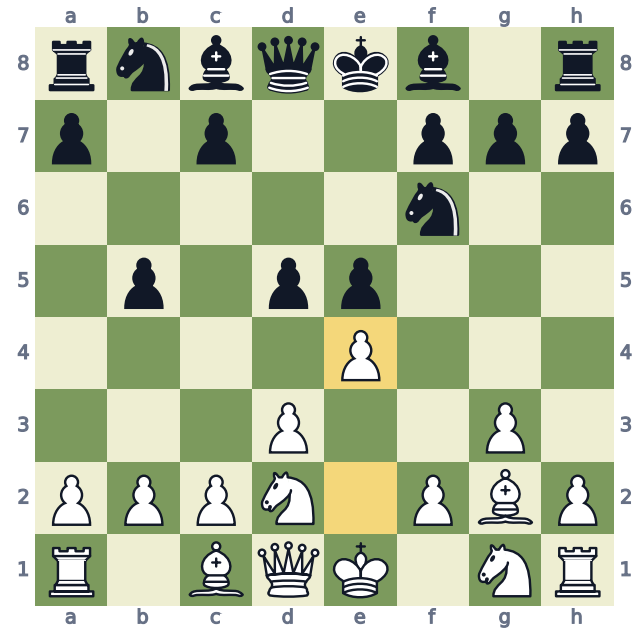
b4 can gain space and restrict c3.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Central occupation comes before hunting an advanced wing pawn.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

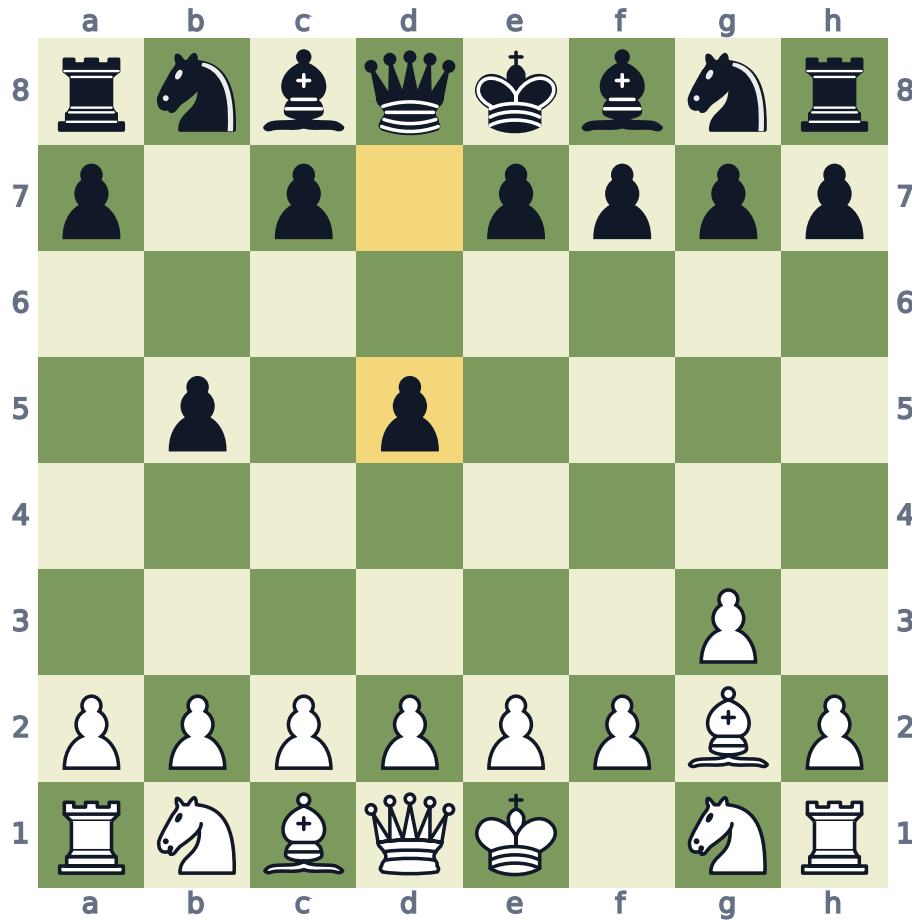
Position estimate: +0.46 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bb7 Ngf3 2. Bd6 O-O 3. Nbd7 a4 4. b4 exd5 5. Bxd5 Nc4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Polish-style b5



YOUR TASK

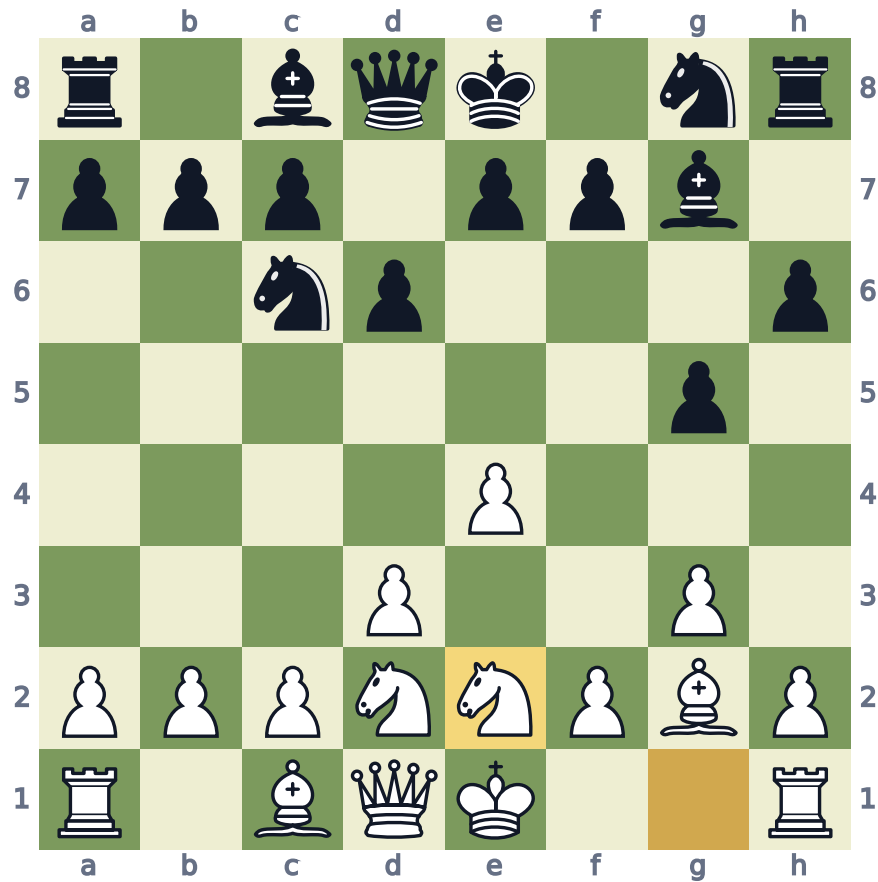
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Borg-style g5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 g5 2. Bg2 h6 3. d3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nd2 Nc6 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

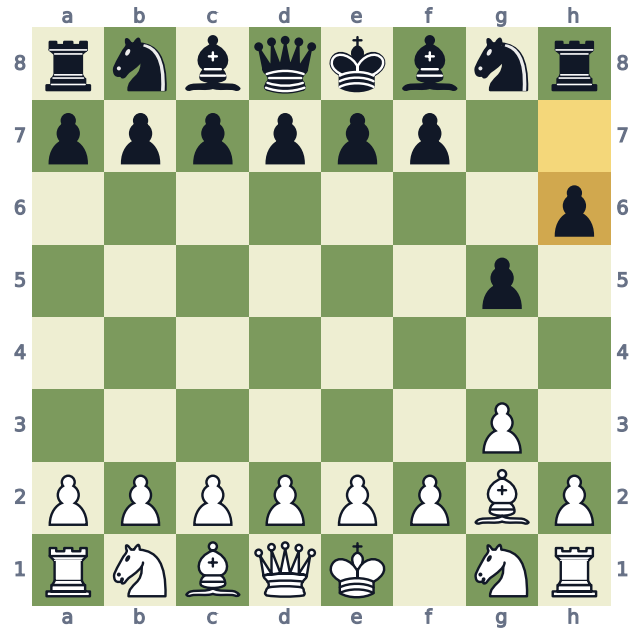
Claim e4 and develop while Black weakens the kingside.

MAIN DANGER

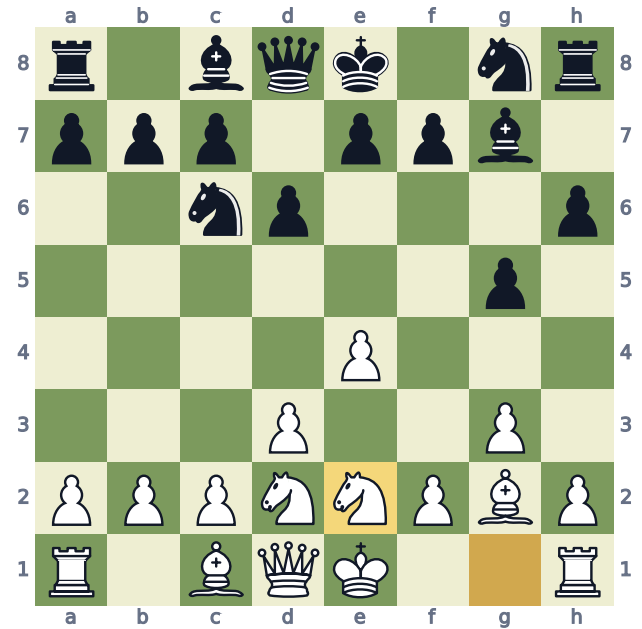
g4 can gain space and attack White's f3 square.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Do not open the h-file before the center and king are secure.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

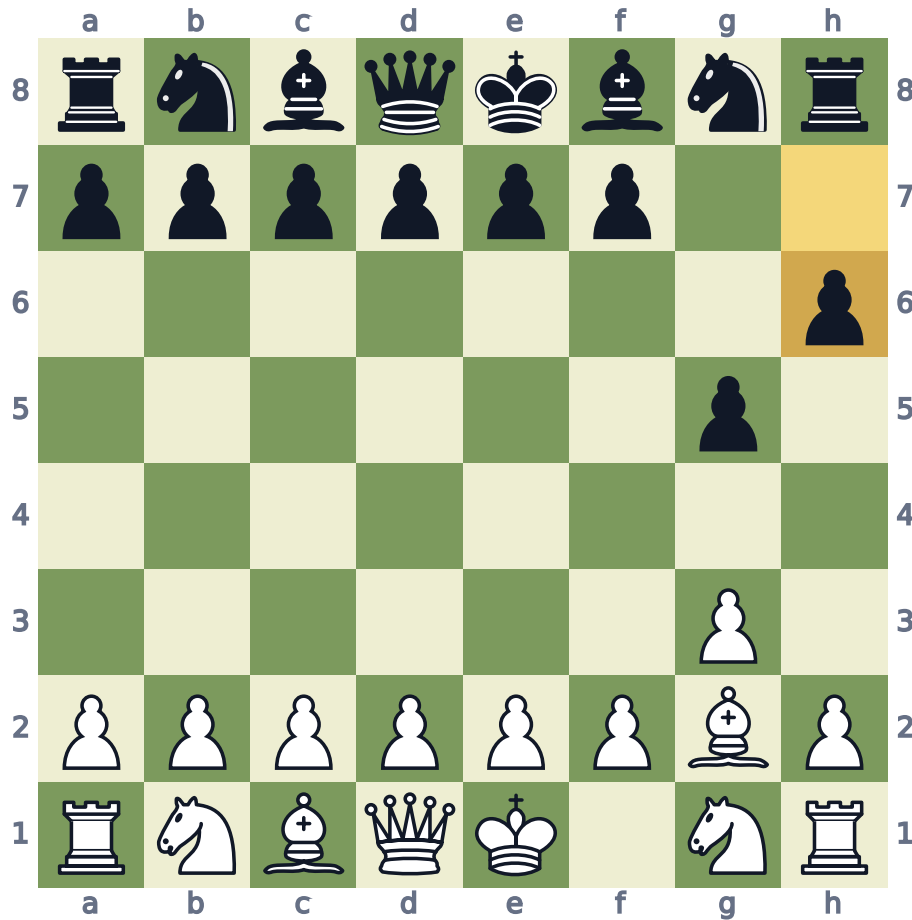
Position estimate: +0.39 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. e5 c3 2. Be6 O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Borg-style g5



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. LENINGRAD DUTCH STRUCTURE

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Occupy e4 and prepare f4 or a central exchange against Black's f-pawn. Engine comparison: 1. e4 fxe4 2. dxe4 d6 3. Nc3 e5 4. f4 Nc6 (+0.44 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: e5 and a kingside attack can arrive rapidly.

02. CLASSICAL DUTCH CENTER

Course move: d3. Purpose: Open the center while Black's king and e6 pawn remain potential targets. Engine comparison: 1. d4 e6 2. Nf3 Be7 3. O-O d5 4. c4 c6 5. b3 (+0.61 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can close the center and support a kingside attack.

03. OWEN QUEENSIDE FIANCHETTO

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use d5 to block the long diagonal and prepare e4 or c4. Engine comparison: 1. c4 Nf6 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. d4 e6 4. e4 Nf6 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: c5 may attack the center before White is ready.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. NIMZOWITSCH-STYLE NC6

Course move: d3. Purpose: Prepare e4 or c4 while Black commits the knight in front of the c-pawn. Engine comparison: 1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 Bb4 3. Nf3 O-O 4. O-O Re8 5. Nd5 e4 (+0.27 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: e4 can gain space and attack Nd2's routes.

05. EARLY H5

Course move: d3. Purpose: Counter the wing advance with central occupation and development. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 c6 2. d4 d5 (+0.12 for White (equal)). Warning: hxg3 can damage the kingside structure.

06. EARLY A6-B5

Course move: d3. Purpose: Use the c6 knight's diagonal block to develop, then occupy e4 and prepare a4. Engine comparison: 1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. O-O d6 4. d4 Nxe4 (+0.74 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: b4 can chase pieces and control c3.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. POLISH-STYLE B5

Course move: d3. Purpose: Build the center and later attack b5 with a4. Engine comparison: 1. e4 dxe4 2. Bxe4 c6 3. Bg2 Nf6 4. d4 Bb7 5. Nf3 e6 (+0.74 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: b4 can gain space and restrict c3.

08. BORG-STYLE G5

Course move: d3. Purpose: Claim e4 and develop while Black weakens the kingside. Engine comparison: 1. h4 Bg7 2. d4 g4 3. e4 d6 4. Nc3 Nc6 5. Be3 (+1.16 for White (White is clearly better)). Warning: g4 can gain space and attack White's f3 square.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.